

Question 48 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Discuss the importance of evaluating training effectiveness for employees and organisations.

Introduction

Evaluation asks whether objectives were met. It is Stage 4 and a duty of HRD. Importance differs slightly for employees (learning and career) and organisations (accountability and improvement), but both need the truth, not only certificates.

Detailed points

- 1. For employees — knowledge of progress.** Tests and coaching after training show what was mastered and what to practise. This is feedback, an HRD right.
- 2. For employees — career evidence.** Documented competence supports growth talks and internal mobility.
- 3. For employees — better future learning.** Their reaction and suggestions improve later programmes. They are stakeholders, not passengers.
- 4. For organisations — accountability.** Training uses money and lost production time. Managers must know return. Notes: effectiveness valued against outcomes related to objectives.
- 5. For organisations — improvement of HRD.** Evaluation locates whether failure was need, design, delivery or transfer. Without it, the same bad course repeats.
- 6. For organisations — strategy.** Level 4 data show if capability for strategy increased. That is why HRD claims strategic status.
- 7. Avoiding illusions.** Happy participants may not perform. Evaluation prevents false security. Also avoids false failure (strict trainer, high learning).
- 8. Credibility of the HRD function.** Systematic evaluation moves HRD from ‘cost centre that arranges picnics’ to a professional function. That importance is political as well as technical.

Conclusion. Split importance: employees (feedback, career, voice) and organisation (accountability, improvement, strategy, truth, HRD credibility). Evaluation protects both development quality and investment.